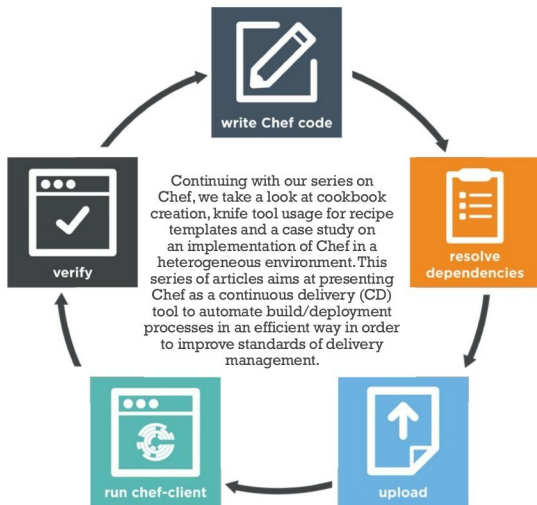


Continuous Integration and Deployment Using Chef



So far, over the course of the previous articles in this series, we have explored the procedure to set up Chef server, the knife tool, the Chef server-agent and how to validate the installations in a typical sandbox environment. We have also introduced Ruby as a reference language that's used to prepare cookbook scripts for the Chef set-up. In this article, we will continue to provide the necessary details on Ruby scripts and will see how easy it is to prepare cookbook patterns using Ruby to configure, deploy and manage Chef agent nodes in a Chef server. A case study of how a Chef environment was set up on a DevOps Journey by the Standard Bank of South Africa is discussed in brief at the end.

The basics of Ruby

Ruby is a complete programming language that can be used for any programming logic like math, string manipulations, writing

business logic, IO operations and more. We have numerous tools such as RubyMine or the NetBeans IDE for writing, testing and validating Ruby scripts inside and outside the Chef container, which is a typical Chef set-up with server configuration that controls all agents and shares cookbook scripts from its store.

In fact, Ruby can be used as a programming language outside Chef Boundary for programming business logic like a Python script, and can be used to test across various platforms like Linux and Windows.

Ruby is bound by a syntax and programming structure and, hence, we need to learn the programming constructs, which is as easy as a Python or Pascal programming construct. We can use the command below to validate the syntax of a given Ruby script:

```
$ ruby -c test.rb
Syntax OK
```